> The world economy is in the midst of a transformative change. One of the most visible outcomes of this transformation is the rise of dynamically emerging market countries at the helm of the global economy. By 2025, emerging economies like Brazil, China, India, Indonesia, and the Russian Federation will likely be significant contributors to global growth, alongside the advanced economies. (World Bank 2011: 13)

Furthermore, Aleksei Arbatov (2013) argues that the United States failed to establish a long-lasting unipolar order. A polycentric system in global affairs replaced the bipolar order. Many power centers like the United States, China, and the EU and some emerging regional powers like India, Brazil, and Japan emerged. Due to this, the unipolar world system could not sustain itself for very long, and a financial crisis increased with globalization. With emerging nations like China, India, and Brazil, and the evolution of middle powers like South Korea, Indonesia, South Africa, and Turkey, a new trend in world affairs was initiated (Toloraya 2013).[4] Emerging countries like China, India, Brazil, and South Africa started claiming an equal stake in global decision-making, especially within financial institutions like the World Bank and IMF, and the reform of the global institutional structure of world politics. Apart from that, over a period, the economic performance of these emerging nations was quite impressive. For instance, the 2010 Annual GDP rate says that China's economic rate was $4.909 trillion, Brazil's was $1.572 trillion, India's economy rate was $1.296 trillion, and Russia's economy was $1231 trillion (Badannath 2010). At the same period, other Global South countries registered an impressive growth rate, like Indonesia at $540 billion, while Mexico's economic rate was $875 billion. Despite the economic recession that had prevailed over the global economy (World Bank Report 2010), the growth rates of these countries' trade and service sectors were improving considerably. Table 2.3 explains this with detailed facts and figures. The data has been taken from the *World Economic Outlook*[5] of the IMF in 2011.

***Table 2.3*** World trade volumes of goods and services (during the global financial crisis) (annual percent change)

| | 2007 | 2008 | 2009 | 2010 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| World Trade Volume (goods and services) | 7.7 | 3.0 | −10.7 | 12.8 |
| Imports | | | | |
| advanced economies | 5.2 | 0.6 | −12.4 | 11.7 |
| Emerging and developing economies | 13.8 | 9.1 | −8.0 | 14.9 |
| Exports | | | | |
| Advanced economies | 6.8 | 2.1 | 11.9 | 12.3 |
| emerging and developing economies | 10.2 | 4.7 | −7.7 | 13.6 |